

Creditors win delay in plan for Manville

By Wayne Beissert
USA TODAY

Trade creditors Monday won a 10-day delay in submission of Manville Corp.'s reorganization plan, which they had previously OK'd.

The Denver-based asbestos maker was ready to file the plan when suppliers interceded hoping that more meetings between the company and another creditor group — asbestosis victims suing the company — can lead to agreement.

A reorganization plan stands a better chance of court approval if all parties support it.

Manville is turning a profit — \$45.7 million on revenue of \$883.7 million in six months this year — but sought protection under federal bankruptcy law in 1982 because it faces as much as \$1.9 billion in asbestos claims from 48,500 suits.

Even with quick court approval, it might be three years before all appeals are exhausted, said Barbara T. Alexander, analyst with Smith Barney, Harris Upham & Co. in New York. "You know someone will challenge (the court decision)."

20055

THKP 0018608